

Critical Thinking & Problem-Solving

For IT Freshers / New Hires

Assessment Duration: 45–60 Minutes

SECTION 1 — CRITICAL THINKING

1. Requirement Clarity

A client says:

“The application is slow during peak hours.”

What should the developer do FIRST?

- A. Rewrite the application
- B. Increase server memory immediately
- C. Gather performance logs and identify bottlenecks
- D. Escalate to management

2. Assumption Testing

A team assumes users are unhappy because of UI colors. However, user complaints mainly mention login delays.

What is the best conclusion?

- A. UI colors are the main issue
- B. Technical performance may be impacting user experience more
- C. Users dislike the product completely
- D. Marketing caused the issue

3. Logical Evaluation

All cloud engineers know Linux. Some developers know Linux.

Which statement is definitely true?

- A. All developers are cloud engineers
- B. Some cloud engineers are developers
- C. Cloud engineers know Linux
- D. Linux experts are developers

4. Prioritization Thinking

A production issue affects 10,000 users, while a UI bug affects only 5 users.

What should be prioritized?

- A. UI bug
- B. Production issue
- C. Both equally
- D. Wait for manager approval

5. Critical Evaluation

A manager says:

“The deployment failed because the developers are inexperienced.”

Which response reflects critical thinking?

- A. Agree immediately
- B. Blame the developers
- C. Investigate logs, deployment process, and environment issues before concluding
- D. Escalate HR concerns

SECTION 2 — PROBLEM-SOLVING SKILLS

6. Debugging Scenario

An application crashes only after users upload large files.

What is the MOST likely first area to investigate?

- A. UI font size
- B. File size handling and memory usage
- C. Internet branding strategy
- D. Employee attendance

7. Time Management Problem

A fresher is assigned 3 urgent tasks with the same deadline.

What should they do FIRST?

- A. Panic and multitask randomly
- B. Ignore one task
- C. Clarify priorities with the lead and estimate effort
- D. Work only on the easiest task

8. Incident Resolution

A payment API suddenly stops responding.

What is the BEST first step?

- A. Restart all systems immediately
- B. Check API logs, server status, and recent deployments
- C. Inform customers the system is permanently down
- D. Delete old database entries

9. Process Improvement

A testing team repeatedly finds the same defects late in the cycle.

What is the BEST improvement approach?

- A. Increase blame discussions
- B. Add earlier automated testing and peer reviews
- C. Skip testing
- D. Reduce documentation

10. Resource Optimization

A report generation process takes 4 hours daily.

What is the BEST solution mindset?

- A. Ignore the issue
- B. Analyze automation or optimization opportunities
- C. Add more manual work
- D. Reduce reporting quality

SECTION 3 — ANALYTICAL DECISION-MAKING

11. Data Interpretation

A website traffic report shows:

Week	Visitors
Week 1	20,000
Week 2	18,000
Week 3	10,000

What should the analyst do FIRST?

- A. Shut down the website
- B. Investigate possible outages or campaign changes
- C. Ignore the trend
- D. Blame developers immediately

12. Risk Analysis

A team wants to deploy directly to production without testing.

What is the biggest risk?

- A. Faster delivery
- B. Reduced documentation
- C. Production failures impacting users
- D. Better innovation

13. Decision Making

A client requests a new feature one day before release.

What is the BEST approach?

- A. Add it immediately without analysis
- B. Evaluate impact on timeline, testing, and stability
- C. Reject all requests permanently
- D. Delay release indefinitely

14. Pattern Recognition

Server CPU spikes happen every day at exactly 9 PM.

What is the MOST logical inference?

- A. Random issue
- B. Possible scheduled batch job or backup process
- C. Hardware theft
- D. Employee login issue

15. Strategic Thinking

A support team receives repeated password reset requests.

What is the BEST long-term solution?

- A. Hire more support staff
- B. Build self-service password reset functionality
- C. Ignore requests
- D. Reduce security

SECTION 4 — IT WORKPLACE SCENARIOS

16. Client Communication

A client is frustrated during a meeting.

What should the fresher do?

- A. Interrupt aggressively
- B. Listen carefully, acknowledge concerns, and respond professionally
- C. Disconnect from the meeting
- D. Blame another team

17. Collaboration

A teammate is blocked because of missing information from you.

What demonstrates ownership?

- A. Ignore the message
- B. Delay response
- C. Share the information promptly and help unblock progress
- D. Escalate unnecessarily

18. Adaptability

A project suddenly changes technology stacks.

What is the BEST response?

- A. Refuse to learn
- B. Complain continuously
- C. Learn the new technology and seek guidance
- D. Quit the project immediately

19. Ethical Thinking

You discover incorrect data in a project report.

What should you do?

- A. Hide the issue
- B. Correct and report it transparently
- C. Ignore it
- D. Blame another person

20. Innovation Mindset

A repetitive manual task consumes 2 hours daily.

What reflects problem-solving thinking?

- A. Continue manually forever
- B. Explore scripts or automation opportunities
- C. Avoid responsibility
- D. Escalate without analysis

SECTION 5 — ROOT CAUSE ANALYSIS

21. 5 Why Analysis

A deployment failed because configuration files were missing.

What should be investigated?

- A. Why configuration validation failed before deployment
- B. Office seating arrangements
- C. Employee cafeteria timings
- D. Client logo design

22. Troubleshooting Logic

Users cannot access an internal portal.

What should be checked FIRST?

- A. Internet memes
- B. Network connectivity and server availability
- C. Employee birthdays
- D. Marketing campaigns

23. Escalation Judgment

When should a fresher escalate an issue?

- A. Immediately for every small issue
- B. After attempting basic troubleshooting and impact assessment
- C. Never escalate
- D. Only after project completion

24. Continuous Improvement

A sprint missed deadlines because tasks were underestimated.

What is the BEST improvement step?

- A. Stop sprint planning
- B. Improve estimation techniques and retrospective analysis
- C. Ignore deadlines
- D. Reduce communication

25. Systems Thinking

An app performs well individually, but slows when multiple services connect.

What is the likely focus area?

- A. Integration and system dependency analysis
- B. Office furniture
- C. Social media trends
- D. Team outing plans